



DuckDuckGo comes to Chrome

Chrome 73 lets you change its default search engine to a more privacy-friendly option like DuckDuckGo. <https://dgit.in/apr19-29>



Play Steam games from anywhere

Beta version of 'Steam Link Anywhere' lets you stream Steam games from anywhere. <https://dgit.in/apr19-30>



Setting up your Linux machine for PC gaming

Playing PC games on Linux-driven machines has become much easier these days.

Abhijit Dey | abhijit@digit.in

L

inux is free. You can simply download it from the internet.

And the best part?

There are more than

hundreds of distributions out there in different flavours to choose from.

While they can carry out most of your daily tasks easily using native or alternative Linux-compatible packages, gaming was something that was highly limited. Now, an increasing number of developers are developing video games to run natively on Linux systems. On Steam, you will come across games compatible with SteamOS and Linux. It indicates that these games will run natively on Linux

without requiring any additional tweaking. All you need to do is search for the game in Steam and install it. But when you browse through your games library, you won't even see the 'Install' button on several games, indicating that they are Windows-only. What do you do then? That's what this article is all about. We will be exploring a few methods using which you will be able to play Windows-only games on your Linux machine. For the purpose of this guide, we used elementary OS 5.0 Juno based on Ubuntu 18.04.2 LTS. Our test rig is running on an AMD Ryzen 1800X CPU and AMD Radeon RX 470 graphics card. We will be assuming you know the basics of using Linux including the installation of packages and using the terminal.

STEP 1: INSTALL YOUR GRAPHICS DRIVERS

If you don't have a discrete graphics card, then you're already using the integrated graphics on your CPU. Almost all the desktop Linux distribu-

tions will install the default drivers on installation, so you won't have to worry about installing them manually. However, if you're using a discrete graphics card from AMD or NVIDIA, you will have to do it on your own. For AMD cards, you will already have the Mesa open source drivers pre-installed. But you can also head over to the AMD website and download the proprietary Radeon drivers. It could provide better performance but it isn't guaranteed. NVIDIA cards need their proprietary drivers in order to get the best performance. You can search for the drivers on your Linux distros

app centre or visit their respective websites to download the packages. For Vulkan support, you will have to manually update it if you are using AMD or Intel. Enter the terminal command: "sudo apt install libvulkan1 libvulkan-dev vulkan-utils". NVIDIA drivers already come bundled with Vulkan support.

STEP 2: INSTALL GAME LAUNCHERS

While you can directly download games, unpack them and play them, an easier approach is to go for game launcher clients such as Steam. Head over to your app centre and search for Steam. After you install it, login into your account and all your purchased games will be listed in your library. You will notice that only Linux-compatible games are listed under SteamOS+Linux. In order to play the Windows-only games, you will have to do some tweaking within Steam.

If you want a universal launcher for all your games, then you can opt for Lutris. It's an open source game library manager that will list all your games in one location. You can download Lutris from <https://dgit.in/Lutris>.